POSITION IN THE 20TH CENTURY

Jainism preaches universal tolerance, and its attitude toward other forms of religion is that of noncriticism; it is not competitive and has never cared for the spread of its faith. Its followers totaled just over 1,600,000 in the early 1960s, with the Digambara majority in the south and the Shvetambaras in the north. Among its followers are found the rich traders and merchants of Gujarat and Maharastra, forming about 0.45 percent of the total population of India.

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